GASTOUNET

Pattern memories and song chaining for Gaston

BASIC HUMAN TASTES

Manual · v2.0.1 · October 2026



Gastounet gives Gaston a memory. Attached to its left, it stores 64 patterns in four banks, switches between them in time with the music and chains them into a song.

It is only a control surface: the patterns and the song live inside Gaston and are saved with it. Gaston always plays one working pattern; Gastounet writes it into a slot, loads another one in its place, or follows a list of song rows.

AT A GLANCE

- 64 patterns: 4 banks of 16, A01 to D16
- WRITE and COPY, armed then aimed at a slot
- Changes on the next step, beat, bar, 2 or 4 bars, or when track 1 loops
- RESTART or LEGATO on every change
- A song of up to 64 rows, 1 to 64 bars each
- Everything is stored in Gaston
- 20 HP, to the left of Gaston only

CONTROLS

Screen	Top line: PATTERN or SONG, the pattern loaded in Gaston (for example A03), EDITED in orange when Gaston's tracks differ from that slot, and BAR · BEAT counted from the start. Below, a status line: what is armed or waiting (WRITE: PICK A SLOT, NEXT: A05 IN 3 BEATS, ROW 2 · BAR 3/8…) or, when nothing is, the LAUNCH and RESTART / LEGATO settings. Then four rows of the song, dimmed in PATTERN mode. Detached, it reads ATTACH TO THE LEFT OF A GASTON.
ROWS	Three buttons that act on the song row selected on the screen. **+ ROW** inserts a 4-bar row after it, with the same pattern (in an empty song, the loaded pattern). **DUP** copies it just below. **– ROW** deletes it.
PATTERN	Pattern mode (default): the slot buttons, NEXT, RANDOM and the PATTERN input change patterns. Also turns SONG REC off.
SONG	Song mode: Gaston follows the song rows. Pressed while playing, the song starts from row 1 on the next bar; stopped, row 1 is loaded at once.
SONG REC	Lights red-orange. Each slot button then adds a 4-bar row at the end of the song. Turning it on also enters SONG mode; press it again to stop adding rows.
END: LOOP / STOP	What happens after the last row. LOOP (default): back to row 1. STOP: Gaston stops and returns to the start.
A · B · C · D	Choose the bank shown on the 16 slot buttons, also used by NEXT, RANDOM and the PATTERN input. On its own, changing bank loads nothing.
01 to 16	The slots of the shown bank. In PATTERN mode a press asks for that pattern, which waits for the LAUNCH grid; stopped, it loads at once. With WRITE or COPY armed, a press picks the slot. In SONG mode they only add rows, with SONG REC lit.
WRITE	Lights red-orange. The next slot pressed receives Gaston's working pattern and becomes the loaded slot. Press WRITE again to cancel.
COPY	Lights ivory. Press the source slot, then the destination. Press COPY again to cancel.
NEXT	Asks for the next filled slot of the shown bank, after the loaded one or after the one already waiting, so repeated presses step forward. With no filled slot, simply the next slot.
RANDOM	Asks for a filled slot of the shown bank, other than the loaded one, at random. Nothing happens if there is none.
LAUNCH	When a requested pattern takes over: see the launch table. Default 1 BAR.
RESTART · LEGATO	RESTART (default): on a change, every track starts again from step 1. LEGATO: the tracks keep their position and cycle, only their content changes.
Right-click menu	Clear slot (the loaded one), Clear bank (the shown one), Clear all patterns, Clear song. They act at once, without confirmation, and leave Gaston's tracks as they are.

LAUNCH

LAUNCH	The new pattern starts	Longest wait at 120 BPM
NOW	On the next step	125 ms
1 BEAT	On the next beat (every 4 steps)	0.5 s
1 BAR	On the next bar (every 16 steps). Default.	2 s
2 BARS	Every 32 steps	4 s
4 BARS	Every 64 steps	8 s
TRACK 1	When Gaston's track 1 comes back to the start of its cycle, at its own LENGTH and DIVISION	2 s for 16 steps at ×1

SLOT BUTTONS

Slot looks	Meaning
Bright number, dot below	Filled
Dim number, no dot	Empty
Brass	Loaded in Gaston
Brass, blinking slowly	Loaded, and Gaston's tracks have changed since (EDITED)
Glowing, blinking fast	Waiting for the launch grid
Red-orange border on every slot	WRITE is armed
Ivory	The COPY source

INPUTS

PATTERN	0 to 10 V across the 16 slots of the shown bank, 0.625 V per slot. A slot is asked for only when the voltage moves into a different one, then waits for LAUNCH like a button press. Changing bank with a steady voltage asks for the same number in the new bank. Ignored in SONG mode.
NEXT	A trigger does what the NEXT button does.
RANDOM	A trigger does what the RANDOM button does.
RESET	SONG mode only: back to row 1, on the next bar while playing, at once when stopped. It does not move Gaston's transport.

OUTPUTS

END	A 10 V, 10 ms trigger each time a pattern is loaded into Gaston: a launched change (even of the same slot), a slot picked while stopped, each new song row, and the end of a song set to END: STOP. CUE does not fire it.

HOW IT WORKS

The memories live in Gaston

Gastounet only sends its buttons and inputs to Gaston. The 64 slots, the song, the loaded slot, the shown bank, the mode and the LAUNCH, RESTART / LEGATO and END settings are stored in Gaston and saved with the patch. WRITE and COPY arming, SONG REC and a waiting change are not saved.

Detach Gastounet and Gaston keeps playing its working pattern, ignores the song and keeps the memories. Attach it again, or attach any Gastounet, and they are all back. With Gastounet attached, Gaston shows the loaded slot at the top of its panel, for example PATTERN A03 · EDITED.

Working pattern and slots

A pattern is all twelve tracks of Gaston: steps, probabilities, voltages and active steps, with LENGTH, DIVISION, direction, range, quantization and slew. Mutes, tempo, swing and Gaston's menu settings are not part of it.

Gaston always plays its working pattern, and you edit it there. Loading another slot replaces it without warning: write it first to keep your changes. Asking again for the loaded slot brings back what was written. An empty slot loads an empty pattern. Writing never interrupts playback.

WRITE and COPY

Both work the same way: arm, then aim. While armed you can change bank first, to write or copy into another bank. Copying a slot onto itself cancels; copying an empty slot empties the destination. COPY does not touch Gaston's working pattern.

Launching

Patterns have no length of their own: LAUNCH decides when a change happens, on a grid counted from the start of the transport. Only one change waits at a time; asking for another slot replaces it. While Gaston is stopped, changes happen at once. RESTART and LEGATO apply to song rows too.

Song mode

A song is a list of up to 64 rows, each a slot and a number of bars (1 to 64). A bar is always 16 steps, and rows change on bar lines. The playing row is shown bright, with an arrow and a bar that fills as it plays. Rows can be edited while the song plays.

In SONG mode the slot buttons, NEXT, RANDOM and the PATTERN input do not change patterns; WRITE and COPY still work. CUE and Gaston's RESET input bring the song back to row 1. With END: STOP, Gaston stops after the last row, returns to the start and loads row 1 again.

Building a song

Press SONG REC, then slots in order: each adds a 4-bar row. Then click a row on the screen to select it and drag vertically on its slot name (any of the 64, A01 to D16) or on its length. The mouse wheel changes the length of the selected row, Shift and the wheel its slot. The list shows four rows and follows the selection: clicking the last visible row scrolls down, the first scrolls up. Rows that point to an empty slot are dimmed.

PATCH IDEAS

1. Live set

Write a groove and its variations into A01 to A04. Keep LAUNCH on 1 BAR and press the next slot a little before the bar line: it blinks until it takes over, exactly on the downbeat.

2. Fill every fourth bar

Write a groove in A01 and a fill in A02. SONG REC, press 01 then 02, set the first row to 3 BARS and the second to 1 BAR. END: LOOP.

3. Endless shuffle

Fill a bank, LAUNCH on 4 BARS, END into RANDOM, then press RANDOM once. Every change sends a trigger that asks for the next one: a new pattern from the bank every 4 bars.

4. Changes off the bar line

Write patterns whose track 1 has a LENGTH of 12, then choose TRACK 1 and LEGATO. Each requested pattern lands when track 1 completes its 12 steps, and the other tracks keep their place.

5. Mark the sections

END into the TRIG of an Ernest with a long DECAY: one hit on each new pattern or song row.

SPECIFICATIONS

Width	20 HP, attached to the left of Gaston
Memories	4 banks of 16 patterns (A01 to D16), stored in Gaston
Song	Up to 64 rows of 1 to 64 bars; 16 steps per bar
Launch	NOW, 1 BEAT, 1 BAR, 2 BARS, 4 BARS, TRACK 1
Levels	PATTERN 0 to 10 V, 0.625 V per slot. NEXT, RANDOM and RESET react above about 1 V. END 10 V, 10 ms.